The Market Exhaled

S&P +0.77%. Crypto explodes. ISM services surge. Oil flattens. VIX collapses 10%.

THE SESSION

The market exhaled. After two days of Hormuz-driven selling that wiped out all 2026 gains, Wednesday delivered the relief rally the tape was begging for. The S&P 500 climbed 0.77% to 6,868.95, the Nasdaq surged 1.28%, and the VIX collapsed nearly 10% to 21.23. The catalyst wasn't a ceasefire — it was data. The ISM Services PMI showed the U.S. service economy expanding at its fastest pace since mid-2022, while the accompanying price index hit an almost one-year low. Translation: growth is holding and energy-driven inflation isn't bleeding into the broader economy yet. The ADP employment report added 48,000 private-sector jobs, more than doubling January's 22,000.

Oil gave back its war premium. Both Brent and WTI dipped into negative territory for the first time since hostilities began, after Treasury Secretary Bessent told CNBC the U.S. would make a series of announcements to support the flow of oil through the Persian Gulf. Tech led the charge — Micron and AMD each rallied roughly 6%, Broadcom and NVDA climbed around 2%, and the Nasdaq 100 jumped 1.6%. But the real fireworks were in crypto. Bitcoin blasted through $73,000 (+6.89%), driven by a trifecta of short-covering from oversold war-positioning, $1.45 billion in spot ETF inflows over five days, and Trump's public push for the Clarity Act stablecoin legislation. Coinbase surged 14.6%.

A container ship was struck at the Strait of Hormuz today, testing Trump's escort guarantee. Despite that, WTI settled near $74 and Brent around $75 — basically flat. The market is telling you it no longer believes Hormuz closes permanently. TLT −0.23%, 10-year holding near 4.07%.

IOWN Tactical: S&P at ~6,870. Still well above our –20% buy trigger from ATH. Three-day pattern: Monday flat, Tuesday −0.9%, Wednesday +0.77%. The war premium is compressing. Watch Broadcom tonight for AI infrastructure signal.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

COIN +14.57% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

The day's monster. Bitcoin's breakout above $73K ignited crypto equities. Trump met with CEO Brian Armstrong, then publicly attacked banks for stalling the Clarity Act.

HUT +13.89% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Yesterday's −9.71% loser became today's second-biggest gainer. The $47-to-$54 round-trip in 24 hours — position sizing matters more than timing.

ETHA +8.84% — DIGITAL ASSET ETF

Ethereum rallied as the Clarity Act narrative lifted the entire crypto complex. Recovered nearly all of Monday's and Tuesday's losses.

HOOD +8.07% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Riding the crypto wave. Robinhood's growing digital asset business makes it a direct Clarity Act beneficiary.

IBIT +7.08% — DIGITAL ASSET ETF

Spot bitcoin ETFs recorded $1.45B in net inflows over five days. Institutional demand is accelerating.

AMD +5.82% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Semiconductor rebound after Tuesday's rout. Reclaimed $200 after touching $188 intraday yesterday.

VLO +3.62% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Second consecutive day as top gainer. Elevated crude continues to widen crack spreads. Now up nearly 5% in two sessions.

PCAR +3.08% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Bounced hard off Tuesday's lows. Truck demand robust; the industrial sell-off looked overdone.

DECLINERS

STLD –1.79% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Steel pricing uncertainty and tariff-related margin compression weighed despite the broader rally.

CVX –1.45% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Crude actually pulled back as Navy escort narrative reduced supply-disruption fears. Monday/Tuesday gains faded.

AEM –0.76% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Gold miners continued to lag as precious metals failed to extend their haven rally.

HOLDINGS NEWS

Broadcom reports fiscal Q1 earnings after the bell. Street expects $2.03 EPS on $19.18B revenue. Not an IOWN holding, but results will set tone for LRCX, ADI, QCOM, and NXPI going into Thursday.

Crypto policy: Trump publicly urged passage of the Clarity Act and attacked banks for stalling. Polymarket gives 73% odds the bill passes in 2026. Kraken became the first crypto firm to access

the Fed's core payment systems. Directly material to COIN, HOOD, IBIT, and ETHA.

Macro data: ISM Services PMI expanded at fastest pace since mid-2022. ADP jobs: 48K (vs. 22K prior). 10-year yield stabilized near 4.07%. Fed Beige Book released without materially shifting rate expectations.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✓ BEAT BOTH

+0.56%

vs. DVY +0.47% | IWS +0.41%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✓ BEAT

+2.09%

vs. IUSG +1.03%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +11.13% vs DVY +9.43% / IWS +7.81%
Growth +2.43% vs IUSG –2.85%